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I Watched My Mac Do 20 Minutes of My Work While I Made Coffee

Claude can now use your Mac like a person would

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Three weeks ago, I was making coffee while my Mac did 20 minutes of my work.

Behind me, it scrolled through my inbox, categorized 80 emails, drafted six replies in my voice, moved a folder of receipts into the right tax year, opened Things 3, and reprioritized my week based on what had slipped from the week before.

I poured the coffee.

When I came back to my desk, the work was done. 80 emails neatly filed, six drafts waiting for my review, receipts in their tax-year folders, and my task list cleaner than it had been in a month.

I have been writing about Apple products for almost a decade, and in that time, I have tested every productivity app that ever existed for macOS. Nothing has changed my workflow this fast.

The Thing Watching My Mac Do My Work is Claude

In March, Anthropic shipped a capability called computer use. It lives inside their Mac app, Cowork, and it does something most AI tools cannot. It takes

screenshots of your screen and acts on what it sees by clicking, typing, scrolling, opening apps, filling forms, etc.

The reason this is a big deal is that every other AI productivity tool needs an API or a plugin to work with an app. But most apps people use in their daily lives, like Apple Mail, Apple Notes, Finder, Things 3, Bear, etc, don't have an API.

Which means until March, the apps you live in were almost entirely off-limits to AI assistance, no matter how mundane the task.

Computer use changes that. If you can see an app on your screen, Claude can use it.

3 Months Later

I have been running computer use as my daily-driver Mac automation since the day Anthropic shipped it. A short list of things it now does that I used to do manually:

Triages my Apple Mail inbox

I get 80 to 120 emails a day. Claude walks through the inbox, proposes a category for each unread message (Reply Today, Reply This Week, Newsletter, Receipt, Archive), and pauses for me to approve in batches. 12 minutes instead of 35.

Sorts my Downloads folder

Every Friday, Claude proposes a destination for every file. Receipts go to the right tax year. Reference docs go to Reference. Screenshots get renamed by content and moved into Pictures. Stale files older than thirty days get flagged for deletion. 12 minutes of clock time, 3 minutes of attention.

Formats messy Craft documents

When I paste raw text from Slack or a podcast transcript into a Craft doc, Claude walks the document and applies my standard formatting. H2 for sections, callouts for quotes, proper list formatting. Saves me 15-20 minutes

per long draft.

Builds my Sunday weekly review

Claude pulls completed tasks from Things 3, upcoming items from Calendar, and stale projects, and produces a single weekly review note in Craft. The thing that used to take 45 minutes now takes 8.

Annotates screenshots for my blog posts

I drop raw screenshots into a folder, and then Claude opens each one in CleanShot X, applies my preset template, exports them as web-optimized PNGs, and renames them with my Medium naming convention. 25 minutes becomes background work while I write the actual post.

Basically, the pattern here is that anything I do repeatedly on my Mac that involves clicking, scrolling, typing, or sorting can be handed off. The routine 60% of my computer work has moved to Claude. The 40% that requires my actual judgment is what I now spend my time on.

That is what actually gets me, and I assume most other people with similar workflows get excited. Not “AI is doing my job.” More like “AI is doing the parts of my job that were never really my job in the first place.”

If you have read this far...

If you have read this far and are thinking, "This sounds amazing, but I have no idea how to actually use it," you are exactly where I was 3 months ago.

The thing nobody tells you about computer use is that it is harder to use well than it looks. Vague prompts produce wrong outcomes. Setup mistakes break the whole loop. The default permissions are confusing. There are real safety considerations that the documentation glosses over. Most people who try it spend an hour, hit one or two failed sessions, and conclude it does not work.

It absolutely does. You just need a system.

When I started, the available resources were Anthropic's developer documentation (which is genuinely good, but written for engineers building computer use into their own apps) and a handful of YouTube demo videos (which show what is possible without teaching you how to do it yourself).

There was no comprehensive playbook for someone like me. Someone who is not a developer. Someone who just wants to use the apps they already have, better, while

drinking their coffee.

So I built one.

What I Built

The Computer Use Playbook for Mac is 196 pages of everything I learned in 3 months of running computer use daily.

It is built for non-developers. No code. No terminal. Just a Mac, Claude Cowork, and the willingness to spend a few hours learning a capability that will save you several hours every week from then on.

Inside:

→ 8 modules covering setup, permissions, safety, prompts, 30 workflows, 8 app deep dives, advanced techniques (scheduled tasks, chaining with connectors, the Dispatch integration), and a full troubleshooting reference.

→ 30 complete workflows in 2-page format. 10 for content creators, 10 for solopreneurs and freelancers, 10 for all knowledge workers. Each one has the exact prompt to copy and paste, the setup notes, what to

expect Claude to do step by step, and how to customize for your own folders and apps.

→ 25 quick-win prompts in a copy-paste bonus library, organized by category (inbox, files, notes, tasks, browser).

→ 8 app-by-app deep dives for Apple Mail, Apple Notes, Reminders, Finder, Safari, Craft, Things 3, and Raycast.

→ The S.E.E.D. prompt framework I built from running hundreds of computer use sessions. The trust ladder for granting Claude access safely. The safety playbook. The troubleshooting guide.

→ Free updates for life. Every time Anthropic ships a new computer use capability, the playbook gets updated and the new version lands in your Gumroad library at no extra cost.

Why This Costs \$39 When There Are Free Resources Out There

A reasonable question. Why pay \$39 when there are tweets, YouTube videos, and Anthropic's documentation, all free?

Because none of those teach you to actually use this.

Tweets are great for inspiration and terrible for

execution. You see someone post a 12-second clip of Claude doing something miraculous on their Mac, and you think I should try that. You go to your Mac, you try to recreate it from memory, and three things go wrong because the tweet did not show the setup, the permissions, the full prompt, or what happens when something fails. You close the chat window and go back to your manual workflow.

YouTube videos have the same problem at greater length. The best ones show what is possible. None of them teach the underlying skill of writing prompts that actually work, recognizing failure modes early, or recovering when things go sideways. A video can show you one workflow. It cannot teach you to design your own.

Anthropic's documentation is genuinely good, and you should read it. But it is written for developers who are building computer use into their own applications. It does not teach you which apps to start with, which to avoid, how to design a daily computer-use practice, or what to do when Claude clicks the wrong thing in Apple Mail.

The Computer Use Playbook for Mac is the resource I needed 3 months ago. It is the resource I built because nobody else had built it. It exists because I burned dozens of hours figuring this out the hard way, and I

wanted to spare anyone else the same path.

Read The First 11 Pages Free First

If you are not sure, do not buy yet. Read the first 11 pages free.

The sample includes the full table of contents, my About page (so you can decide whether you trust the source), the introduction chapter explaining what computer use actually is, the who-this-is-for and who-this-is-not-for sections, the pre-flight checklist of what you need before starting, an honest take on the research-preview limitations, and the format every workflow follows.

If the writing fits, if the structure fits, if the depth fits, the full playbook is there. If it does not, you have spent fifteen minutes reading a free primer on a capability that is quietly changing how people use their Macs.

You can grab the free sample from the link below:

Claude Computer Use Playbook for Mac - Free Sample

The first 11 pages of the Claude Computer Use Playbook for Mac, free. This sample...

theusefultech.gumroad.com

The full playbook is at the link below for \$39, but if you are a The Useful Tech Discord member, then you get an

exclusive 35% off, valid till Sunday. You can join from the link in my bio or at the end of the post.

Claude Computer Use Playbook for Mac

Make your Mac run itself with Claude. In March 2026, Anthropic shipped compute...

theusefultech.gumroad.com

Where We Are

Computer use is real. It is here. It is available right now to anyone with a Pro or Max Claude plan and Cowork installed on their Mac.

The question is no longer whether AI can do work on your Mac. The question is whether you are going to learn how to direct it, or whether you are going to watch everyone else move faster while you keep doing the same routine work by hand.

3 weeks ago, I made coffee while my Mac did twenty minutes of my work. Last week, it ran 6 hours of work in the background of my week. Next month it will be more.

Your Mac is waiting. You just have to know how to ask.

If you got value from this, follow me here on Medium for more practical Apple and AI workflow writing. I publish every week at The Useful Tech. If you want the community version of this, the free Useful Tech Club Discord is at discord.gg/WjfenUSZp4.

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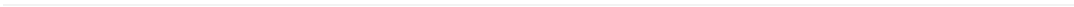
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